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Udayana (1050–1100): realist philosopher who combined the ***Nyaya*** tradition of logic and epistemology with the ***Vaisheshika*** system of metaphysical categories and refuted a wide range of Buddhist theories. His major works include the *Atmatattvaviveka* in which he attacks many Buddhist doctrines. He rejects the view that everything is momentary as a prelude to establishing the reality of eternally enduring, omnipresent souls distinct from the body. He argues for the existence of a mind-independent world. He maintains that the possessor of properties is a reality actually and logically distinct from those properties (otherwise the soul would be inseparable from the stream of transitory experiences) and controverts the theory of the followers of ***Nagarjuna*** that everything is relative and empty (***shunya***) of own-nature (***svabhava***). Finally he refutes the anti-realist theory that what is not perceived by humans does not exist. The *Kiranavali* and the *Lakshanavali* belong to the ***Vaisheshika*** tradition of defining the fundamental categories of reality. The *Nyayavarttikatatparyaparishuddhi* is a contribution to logic and the theory of knowledge. The *Lakshanamala* synthesises ***Nyaya*** and ***Vaisheshika*** doctrines and techniques. The *Nyayakusumanjali* presents inferential proofs of the existence of God as an omniscient creator. The scriptures speak of God, but they are insufficient to prove his existence. We cannot say that God gives us the scriptures and then use those scriptures to prove the existence of God. Udayana formulates many arguments to demonstrate the existence of an all-knowing and all-powerful divinity who is the creator, preserver and destroyer of the repetitive cosmic process to which he is compassionately disposed.

Further reading: Chemparathy 1972; Potter 1977; Tachikawa 1981